



Outlook

Re: FTDS Dev Expreience.

Desde Rahul Patel <rppatel@rockwellautomation.com>

Fecha Jue 16/07/2026 10:53

Para Tim Florencki <TJFloren@rockwellautomation.com>; Bill Stoltenberg <bhstolte@rockwellautomation.com>; Petr Louda <PLouda@rockwellautomation.com>; Daniel Rischar <Daniel.Rischar@rockwellautomation.com>; Carlos Alberto Zapata Medina <Carlos.Zapata@rockwellautomation.com>; Juan David Carrasquilla Arango <JUANDAVID.CARRASQUILLAARANGO@rockwellautomation.com>; Wei Hu <whu@rockwellautomation.com>; Rosanna Navarro <rnavarro@rockwellautomation.com>; Ravindra Mahangare <rsmahang@rockwellautomation.com>

Agreed objective that helps us measure cycle times in dealing with infrastructure and subjective on dev experience perception.

Smoothing this out is also key to Agentic Engineering OS and its success.

Thanks

Rahul

(440) 382 9261

From: Tim Florencki <TJFloren@rockwellautomation.com>

Date: Wednesday, July 15, 2026 at 3:25 PM

To: Bill Stoltenberg <bhstolte@rockwellautomation.com>; Rahul Patel <rppatel@rockwellautomation.com>; Petr Louda <PLouda@rockwellautomation.com>; Daniel Rischar <Daniel.Rischar@rockwellautomation.com>; Carlos Alberto Zapata Medina <Carlos.Zapata@rockwellautomation.com>; Juan David Carrasquilla Arango <JUANDAVID.CARRASQUILLAARANGO@rockwellautomation.com>; Wei Hu <whu@rockwellautomation.com>; Rosanna Navarro <rnavarro@rockwellautomation.com>; Ravindra Mahangare <rsmahang@rockwellautomation.com>

Subject: Re: FTDS Dev Expreience.

Would be good to have some objective measures as well.

Please include more details below, particularly if your rating is 3 or below. What obstacles you ran into and any suggested changes / solutions.

Bill

From: Rahul Patel <rppatel@rockwellautomation.com>
Sent: Wednesday, July 15, 2026 12:28 PM
To: Petr Louda <PLouda@rockwellautomation.com>; Tim Florencki <TJFloren@rockwellautomation.com>; Bill Stoltenberg <bhstolte@rockwellautomation.com>; Daniel Rischar <Daniel.Rischar@rockwellautomation.com>; Carlos Alberto Zapata Medina <Carlos.Zapata@rockwellautomation.com>; Juan David Carrasquilla Arango <JUANDAVID.CARRASQUILLAARANGO@rockwellautomation.com>; Wei Hu <whu@rockwellautomation.com>; Rosanna Navarro <rnavarro@rockwellautomation.com>; Ravindra Mahangare <rsmahang@rockwellautomation.com>
Subject: Re: FTDS Dev Expreience.

Thanks All !!

Bill - Agreed we have a lot of work in progress, that is partly what I am trying to get a better visibility adn connect to outcomes, we have lot of good/great work in progress across pockets in the programs. How well they are connected, prioritized adn building on top of each other where needed - so we drive maximum gains.

How are we measuring and tracking dev experience and productivity?

Piotr - thanks for Volunteering, Bill, Carlos, Piotr and Patrick Leduc ([@Tim Florencki](#)) to confirm - do we have a fellowship ?

Thanks
Rahul
(440) 382 9261

From: Petr Louda <PLouda@rockwellautomation.com>
Date: Wednesday, July 15, 2026 at 1:15 PM
To: Tim Florencki <TJFloren@rockwellautomation.com>; Bill Stoltenberg <bhstolte@rockwellautomation.com>; Daniel Rischar <Daniel.Rischar@rockwellautomation.com>; Rahul Patel <rppatel@rockwellautomation.com>; Carlos Alberto Zapata Medina <Carlos.Zapata@rockwellautomation.com>; Juan David Carrasquilla Arango <JUANDAVID.CARRASQUILLAARANGO@rockwellautomation.com>; Wei Hu <whu@rockwellautomation.com>; Rosanna Navarro <rnavarro@rockwellautomation.com>; Ravindra Mahangare

<rsmahang@rockwellautomation.com>

Subject: Re: FTDS Dev Expreience.

When I was thinking about this in the last few days...besides what was already mentioned, I see issues like:

- **Tests are flaky.**
 - Some tests are not well written.
 - Infrastructure and architecture related topics impact test stability and need to have updates of the product/Jenkins/infrastructure with strict maintenance window, where nobody can use the product (dev/QA/preprod/prod whatever) >>> zero risk policy is also a factor.
 - Product design directly and indirectly impacts infrastructure and testing, I can elaborate on that in small group.
- **Product and infrastructure are sometimes slow.**
 - Device profiles that are chatty are really sensitive to network latency due to the geographical distribution of developers vs. devices vs. backend. There is an effort that is working on gathering precise measurements with some cost numbers and implications into people's hour costs to allow informed decisions into how our infrastructure is architected.
 - As mentioned about Rancher, deployment of FTDS on Rancher is not done in like 3 minutes. >>> One of the big reasons for frustration.
- **Compounded consequences on developer experience:**
 - Teams re-run tests after comparing to main or other branches, so the flakiness burns people's time and they burn CPU time in CI / CD systems.
 - Individual contributors get frustrated and get under pressure for delivering stories, Anomalies and Features, thus search for any possible way to merge despite instability and issues. And overall quality goes down, which further escalates the issues.
 - Thanks to two teams I have direct visibility into and those work differently and in different areas, I have comparison for testing and these infra/product issues. I can elaborate on those in the smaller group.

[@Rahul Patel](#) [@Bill Stoltenberg](#) [@Carlos Alberto Zapata Medina](#) - I am volunteering to support the effort, if you need my help. 😊

Petr Louda

Manager, Research and Development

Rockwell Automation | Argentinská 1610/4, 170 00 Prague 7, Czech Republic

M: plouda@rockwellautomation.com | M: +420 602 445 856 |

From: Tim Florencki <TJFloren@rockwellautomation.com>
Sent: Tuesday, July 14, 2026 8:02 PM
To: Bill Stoltenberg <bhstolte@rockwellautomation.com>; Daniel Rischar <Daniel.Rischar@rockwellautomation.com>; Rahul Patel <rppatel@rockwellautomation.com>; Carlos Alberto Zapata Medina <Carlos.Zapata@rockwellautomation.com>; Juan David Carrasquilla Arango <JUANDAVID.CARRASQUILLAARANGO@rockwellautomation.com>; Wei Hu <whu@rockwellautomation.com>; Rosanna Navarro <rnavarro@rockwellautomation.com>; Ravindra Mahangare <rsmahang@rockwellautomation.com>; Petr Louda <PLouda@rockwellautomation.com>
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For me, I think a thing that has been missing is to quantify how much we have moved the needle. I think we need to standardize on some key metrics and regularly monitor those. We can then see how each initiative moves the needle (or not) and can be transparent/aligned across the program on how we manage this.

Thanks,
Tim

From: Bill Stoltenberg <bhstolte@rockwellautomation.com>
Sent: Tuesday, July 14, 2026 11:25 AM
To: Daniel Rischar <Daniel.Rischar@rockwellautomation.com>; Rahul Patel <rppatel@rockwellautomation.com>; Carlos Alberto Zapata Medina <Carlos.Zapata@rockwellautomation.com>; Juan David Carrasquilla Arango <JUANDAVID.CARRASQUILLAARANGO@rockwellautomation.com>; Tim Florencki <TJFloren@rockwellautomation.com>; Wei Hu <whu@rockwellautomation.com>; Rosanna Navarro <rnavarro@rockwellautomation.com>; Ravindra Mahangare <rsmahang@rockwellautomation.com>; Petr Louda <PLouda@rockwellautomation.com>
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We have a lot of work in progress involving the testing aspect of this process. Soon, we will have a new test platform to replace STEX and the E2E tests will be run with GitHub Actions. I think a lot of problems people are experiencing are related to the STEX based system. Once the new platform is in place, getting feedback on the overall flow will be important to see what is still slowing people down.

I think the survey Dan mentioned below will be helpful. Maybe we should also send out a more general survey to make sure we understand all the pain points and suggested solutions? There could be other areas we can work on that do not overlap with the changes that are already in progress. I do still hear about problems with Rancher, obviously, this tool has limitations. Maybe we should see if there is a different tool that we can use for this purpose?

Bill

From: Daniel Rischar <Daniel.Rischar@rockwellautomation.com>

Sent: Monday, July 13, 2026 9:27 AM

To: Rahul Patel <rppatel@rockwellautomation.com>; Bill Stoltenberg <bhstolte@rockwellautomation.com>; Carlos Alberto Zapata Medina <Carlos.Zapata@rockwellautomation.com>; Juan David Carrasquilla Arango <JUANDAVID.CARRASQUILLAARANGO@rockwellautomation.com>; Tim Florencki <TJFloren@rockwellautomation.com>; Wei Hu <whu@rockwellautomation.com>; Rosanna Navarro <rnavarro@rockwellautomation.com>; Ravindra Mahangare <rsmahang@rockwellautomation.com>; Petr Louda <PLouda@rockwellautomation.com>

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I want to connect this to the architectural evaluation work we ran early this year and have made some (albeit slow) progress on since.

At that time, architects performed an assessment of key product problem areas, scoring them across **friction, complexity, and blast radius**. The intent was to quantify where architecture is directly impacting speed of delivery from design to release (and therefore the holistic developer experience).

Two observations that are worth highlighting:

- The highest-friction items skewed toward the tail end of the dev workflow (test, merge, validation), rather than onboarding or initial development
- Even highly capable teams (e.g., tab splitting as done by UI and L&E vertical architects, backend language client with SpecialOps) experienced significant delays due to slow, inconsistent, and difficult to debug validations.

A few follow-on efforts have already spun out of that work.

- Architecture guidance documentation in ra-docs (helps evaluate a change for impact across the product)
- XServices impact survey across dev pods (Karl Staas et al, sent in June, results will be published soon). This especially would be a valuable input to improving the DevEx.
- Event-driven architecture/service isolation (Kevin Fonner et al, reviewed by ARB, with an initial incremental approach headed toward LPM).

- Dan

From: Rahul Patel <rppatel@rockwellautomation.com>

Sent: Monday, July 13, 2026 8:00 AM

To: Bill Stoltenberg <bhstolte@rockwellautomation.com>; Carlos Alberto Zapata Medina <Carlos.Zapata@rockwellautomation.com>; Juan David Carrasquilla Arango <JUANDAVID.CARRASQUILLAARANGO@rockwellautomation.com>; Tim Florencki <TJFloren@rockwellautomation.com>; Wei Hu <whu@rockwellautomation.com>; Rosanna Navarro <rnavarro@rockwellautomation.com>; Ravindra Mahangare <rsmahang@rockwellautomation.com>; Petr Louda <PLouda@rockwellautomation.com>; Daniel Rischar <Daniel.Rischar@rockwellautomation.com>; Rahul Patel <rppatel@rockwellautomation.com>

Subject: FTDS Dev Expreience.

All —Dev Experience keeps surfacing in skip-levels, so I want to address it head-on: developer experience in FTDS remains poor, no surprise there. Environment setup, merge cycles, debugging — all of it is slower and more painful than it should be, spanning both our pipeline/infrastructure and the product and codebase itself.

We've invested in this almost every year — refactors (Ladder, Tag Editor, XServices), expanded test coverage and shift-left, infrastructure investments like GitHub and observability, and now test infrastructure. Each effort moved the needle somewhat, but we're nowhere near where we need to be. A weak dev experience is killing engineering velocity today, and it will become a hard ceiling as we accelerate into agentic AI development. We've tried to focus on shift from DevOps to Platform Engineering, had FY goals around it — and it hasn't moved the way it needs to.

This is an urgent and high priority for me. It also has direct overlap with the AI in DevOps conversation Bill, Carlos, Ravi and I had last week.

Stepping back what's been missing is a sustained, **holistic** focus with measurable outcomes — not a one-off project. That needs to change:

The goal: measurable improvement in developer experience, tracked by cycle time and effort across the full developer workflow. They are the customers — from spinning up a dev environment to getting code to main. Maximum time must be spent on development and debugging. Minimum time fighting the environment and pipelines

How we run it: I want a small team of 2–4 engineering leaders owning this end-to-end: establish baseline metrics, orchestrate initiatives (have a 360 view), and continuously revalidate against that baseline. Bill and Carlos are two of those leaders. This runs like any other investment — I'm the primary stakeholder, with Tim, Wei, JD - or their delegates as other stakeholders. Stakeholders attend this as committed not involved. We fold in both threads of AI work: AI improving internal DevOps productivity, and AI improving developer experience directly into this effort. The boundaries between Cheetah, Pegasus, and other workstreams are internal org constructs — they shouldn't get in the way of the outcome.

One more thing before we move: **In keeping with our tenants, this needs to be a Disagree and Commit** . We're in the pre-commit phase. If you see a different approach, a problem with the scope, or a better way to structure this, now is the time to push back, propose an alternative, or debate the framing. Once we align and commit, we march — no revisiting, unless data/facts force us. Bring your honest read to the conversation.

This will also help us sharpen our effort across the DevOps/Ops teams to three areas, all underpinned by Agentic AI usage maturity. These become focus for remainder of the year and going into next.

- Significantly improved Developer Experience through ownership of Platform Engineering — This effort.
- Uptime, SRE, and Release Engineering - Already a primary goal
- FinOps - Already a goal

Thanks ! — Let's have a debate, let the email threads fly a bit - I will schedule follow ups that will turn into trackers and status updates.

Rahul Patel

(440) 382 9261